

1710 ▶ 1730



Illustration of Halley's diving bell, from a 19th-century encyclopedia

“The whole cavity of the bell was kept entirely free from water, so that I sat on a bench... with all my clothes on.”

Edmond Halley, on going underwater in the diving bell, 1715

1715

Halley's diving bell

English scientist Edmond Halley designed a practical diving bell. An air-filled, weighted barrel was suspended next to the bell and kept it constantly fed with air through a hose. Halley dived to a depth of 60 ft (18 m) inside his bell and remained submerged for 90 minutes. Diving bells were used to recover goods from sunken ships.



1710

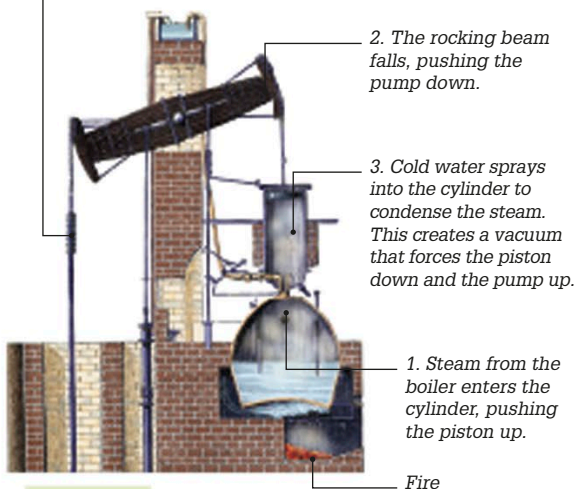
1715

1712

Practical steam engine

Thomas Newcomen, an English engineer, built the world's first practical steam engine, designed to pump water out of mines. A growing demand for coal meant that mines were being dug deeper, and flooding was a serious problem.

4. The up-and-down action of the pump expels water from the mine.



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Diagram of Newcomen's steam engine

1716 MALARIA



Female *Anopheles* mosquito

Italian physician Giovanni Lancisi argued that mosquitoes, which breed in swamps, are responsible for spreading malaria. Few people believed him at the time, but he was proved right in 1894.

Malaria lifecycle

Malaria is transmitted to humans in the bite of infected female *Anopheles* mosquitoes. Tiny parasites from the mosquito's saliva enter the victim's bloodstream and multiply in the liver, causing fever.

